had slipped into Montreal from the USA. Though the FBI had been keeping an eye on suspected Sikh militants in Queens, New York, since 1983, their surveillance was merely to ensure that the militants did not carry out terror activities on US soil. Two Sikh militants, Ammand Singh and Lal Singh, thus managed to secure false passports and fly out of New York to take down the Air India flight.

Many Khalistan supporters in Canada had called for a boycott of the airline and when Talvinder Singh Parmar made a fiery speech at a Sikh temple in South East Calgary in the summer of 1984, he said that Air India planes would fall from the sky. The report said:

The local press has described a controversy that has developed between the Royal Canadian Mounted Police (RCMP) and Canadian Intelligence over the conduct of the investigation and whether or not the tragedy could have been prevented. According to press reports, months before the bombing the RCMP investigated a tip that an Air India plane out of Montreal would be bombed. The RCMP had asked Canadian intelligence for a threat assessment of its likelihood. Police critics suggest that Canadian intelligence ignored clues that could have prevented the bombing. There have also

been allegations that there was a Canadian intelligence mole working with the alleged bombing conspirators.

The FBI on its part raided Sikh localities in Queens and interrogated suspects. The agency claimed to have arrested some Sikh militants including Gurpartap Birk, an alleged gang leader, but trails leading to many others were untouched.